

If I had to pick one thing that stuck with me the most from this course, it's the idea that being a "good" engineer doesn't just mean being technically smart, it means being thoughtful about how your work affects the world. Before this class, I really only saw engineering as solving problems in the fastest, most efficient way. I didn't always stop to think about who defines the problem, who benefits from the solution, or who might get left out. That's changed. The discussions, especially the ones where we looked at real-world cases made me realize that the decisions we make, even the small ones, have weight. It made me start asking more questions. Who's affected? What are we assuming? Could this cause harm?

That mindset is something I'll carry with me. I've always been someone who loves building and solving things, but now I understand that the "how" and "why" matter just as much as the "what."

One thing I wish I had developed more during the class was the ability to talk through ethical "gray areas." I noticed that I'd sometimes go quiet when the conversation got really nuanced or philosophical, not because I didn't care, but because I wasn't sure what I thought. I wish I had pushed myself more to speak up, even when I wasn't totally sure where I stood. That's something I'll keep working on, being okay with not having a perfect answer and just being open to thinking it through out loud.

Looking back at my first term reflection, I'd probably update my definition of what makes an engineer ethical. Originally, I said things like honesty, accountability, and being technically competent, and I still stand by those. But after going through this course, I'd add things like humility, empathy, and the ability to speak up when something doesn't sit right. It's easy to get caught up in the technical details and forget the human side, but this course reminded me that our work touches people's lives. That matters.

One way I think I've already started to embody some of these traits was during our final project in embedded systems. We had to decide how to present data from the sensors in our GUI, and I pushed for making it as clear and user-friendly as possible, not just because it looked cleaner, but because I felt like if someone else had to use it, they should be able to understand

what's going on without confusion. I also made sure we documented our code well so that our work wouldn't be a mystery to anyone who came after us.

That said, I know I'm still working on other parts. Like, I don't always feel confident calling things out when I think something's off, especially in group work when everyone seems to be going along with a decision. I worry about creating tension or making things awkward, but I know that's not a good excuse. If I want to grow as an ethical engineer, I have to learn how to voice concerns respectfully and be okay with being the one to ask hard questions. I think with more experience, and probably by learning from others who do it well, I'll get better at that.

If I'm being honest, I'd give myself a 4 out of 5 for participation in the second half of the semester. I wasn't the loudest voice in class, but I made a conscious effort to engage more especially in group activities and when we worked through real-world ethical problems. I found that when the conversations got practical, I had more to contribute.

What helped me the most was the way the class was set up. It didn't feel like you had to fight for attention or always have the "right" answer. That made it easier to jump in. The weekly reflections also helped me process my thoughts in a low-pressure way.

Something that made it harder, though, was just my own hesitation when the topics were abstract. I sometimes felt unsure about where I stood or worried about saying something that didn't make sense. I think more opportunities for small-group discussions might have helped me get more comfortable with speaking up.

If I could talk to someone taking this class next semester, I'd say, don't treat this like a checkbox class. It's not just about ethics in theory, it's about the kind of engineer you want to be. Take it seriously, because it really does make you think differently. Ask questions, even if you're unsure, and try to connect what we talk about in class to stuff you're already doing. You'll get more out of it that way.

Looking further ahead, I know I'll carry this perspective into whatever role I end up in. Whether I'm working on software, systems, or something totally new, I want to keep asking the hard questions. I want to be someone who builds things that are safe, fair, and helpful, and who's not afraid to push back when something doesn't feel right. In five or ten years, I hope I'm part of

a team or company where ethics is something we talk about openly, not just something we assume.

I'm still curious about how ethics is handled inside real engineering teams or tech companies. Like, we've talked about individual responsibility a lot, but I'd love to learn more about how teams navigate disagreements or when someone raises a concern. Do companies actually make space for that kind of dialogue? And if not, how can someone new in their career start those conversations?

As for the class itself, I thought it was really well-structured, but maybe adding a few more success stories, like times when engineers did the right thing and made a difference, would be an improvement. Overall, I had a great time and felt like this class made me become a better person overall.